

Half Marathon Training

24-Week Beginner Program

Program Details

Distance:	21.1 kilometers (13.1 miles)
Duration:	24 weeks (6 months)
Level:	Beginner
Training Days:	3-4 days per week

Program Overview

This 24-week beginner half marathon training plan is designed for runners who are new to the half marathon distance and want a gradual, sustainable approach to training.

Training Phases

- Weeks 1-8: Foundation Phase - Build base fitness with 3 runs per week
- Weeks 9-16: Build Phase - Increase volume and introduce speed work
- Weeks 17-23: Peak Phase - Longest runs and highest training load
- Week 24: Taper Week - Reduce training to rest up for race day

Weekly Training Schedule

Week 1							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
1	Rest	Easy	Cross	Int	Rest	Cross	Long
		25m	30m	20m		30m	35m

Week 2							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
2	Rest	Easy	Cross	Int	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 3							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
3	Rest	Easy	Cross	Int	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 4							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
4	Rest	Easy	Cross	Int	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 5							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
5	Rest	Easy	Cross	Int	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 6							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
6	Rest	Easy	Cross	Int	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 7							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
7	Rest	Easy	Cross	Int	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 8							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
8	Rest	Easy	Cross	Int	Rest	Cross	Long
		30m	30m	25m		30m	45m

Week 9							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
9	Rest	Easy	Cross	Tempo	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 10							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
10	Rest	Easy	Cross	Tempo	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 11							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
11	Rest	Easy	Cross	Tempo	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 12							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
12	Rest	Easy	Cross	Int	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 13							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
13	Rest	Easy	Cross	Tempo	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 14							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
14	Rest	Easy	Cross	Tempo	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 15							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
15	Rest	Easy	Cross	Tempo	Rest	Cross	Long
		50m	50m	45m		55m	85m

Week 16							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
16	Rest	Easy	Cross	Int	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 17							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
17	Rest	Easy	Cross	Tempo	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 18							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
18	Rest	Easy	Cross	Tempo	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 19							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
19	Rest	Easy	Cross	Tempo	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 20							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
20	Rest	Easy	Cross	Int	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 21							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
21	Rest	Easy	Cross	Tempo	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 22							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
22	Rest	Easy	Cross	Tempo	Rest	Cross	Long
		60m	65m	60m		65m	120m

Week 23							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
23	Rest	Easy	Cross	Tempo	Rest	Cross	Long
Week 24							
Day	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
24	Rest	Easy	Cross	Easy	Rest	Rest	HALF
		35m	30m	25m			MARATHON

Workout Definitions

Easy Run: Run at a comfortable, conversational pace. Heart rate Zone 1-2 (65-75% max).

Long Run: The most important workout. Run at easy pace, slower than normal runs.

Intervals: Speed work with periods of harder running followed by recovery.

Tempo Run: Comfortably hard pace that you could sustain for about an hour.

Cross Training: Low-impact cardio like cycling, swimming, or elliptical.

Training Principles

- 70-80% of training should be at low intensity (easy pace)
- Rest weeks (every 4th week) are crucial for adaptation
- The long run is the most important workout
- Cross-training helps prevent overuse injuries
- Listen to your body - take extra rest if needed